GUHSD Athletics Funding — At a Glance

GUHSD is the 3rd-highest per-student-spending HSD in San Diego County, with general-fund reserves $20.8M above the state-required minimum. At Granite Hills, part of athletics costs is paid through family booster fundraising and student ASB trust accounts.

PER-STUDENT SPENDING (HSD)
$21,618
3rd-highest in SD County. Above Sweetwater, Poway, San Marcos, Oceanside, San Dieguito.

GENERAL-FUND RESERVES
$31.2M
$20.8M above the 3% state-required minimum.

GRANITE HILLS ASB / BOOSTER-PAID (FY 25-26)
$159K+
$96K trust coach pay + $35K officials difference + $28K non-league/clearance/etc., at one site.

DISTRICT OFFICIALS ALLOCATION
$22K / school
Covered 38% of verified FY 25-26 competition overhead at Granite Hills ($57,393).

The seven findings

#	TOPIC	KEY METRIC	ONE-LINE FINDING
1	**Athletic Trainers**	**$35 / hr**	GUHSD pays its AT a $22,500 stipend (~$35/hr); CATA recommends **$67–$73/hr** for SoCal Region 5–6. Six of seven verified SD County peers staff AT as full-time classified. See also Pierpoint 2018 (6× / 3× recurrent injury rate ratios) and Morgan Hill OCR 2023 (Title IX).
2	**Coaching Stipends**	**$1,190–$1,640 difference**	Helix Charter (in the Grossmont League) pays head varsity football **$1,190–$1,640 more** than GUHSD at every experience tier (2025-26 schedule). Sweetwater pays 40% more at entry. AD comparison: GUHSD second-lowest in the SD County peer set at $6,227 top tier vs. Helix $13,675 / Steele Canyon $13,434. ★ **Helix is ranked #14 in California (USA Today HSS / Niche, Apr 29 2026)** — no GUHSD comprehensive site appears in the top 25.
3	**Attendance & LCFF**	**+$1.7M / pp ADA**	AEI April 2026 report (n=262,600): athletes **12.9 pp less likely to be chronically absent**; effect 2× larger for low-income students. 1 pp attendance ≈ **$1.7M+ in CA LCFF revenue**.
4	**Walk-On Coaches**	**52-slot cap**	GUHSD caps stipends at 52 per school across 24+ sports; positions above the cap are unpaid or booster-funded. LAUSD reported 58% walk-on coaches (2013–14). At Granite Hills, 52 stipends are split across 58 coaches.
5	**Officials & Ref Fees**	**38% district share**	GUHSD allocates $22,000/school. Granite Hills FY 2025-26 verified competition overhead: **$57,393**. District covers 38%; ASB / boosters cover the remaining **$35,393**. CHSSO 2025-26 fee schedule verified for every major sport.
6	**Coaching Paid via ASB**	**$96,009**	Granite Hills paid **$96,009** from trust accounts to compensate 53 coaches not on district stipend, authorized through the GUHSD "Request To Pay Coach – Trust" Google Form and routed through district HR via PAF. + $27,710 non-league officials/clearance/etc. = **$123,719+** paid through ASB at one site.
7	**The Research Case**	**99.4% grad rate**	NFHS-compiled research + AEI 2026: athletes graduate at **99.4% vs. 93.5%**, carry **+0.81 GPA**, and miss ~half as many school days; differences are largest for low-income students. NFHS national norm for activities funding: 1–3% of budget.

PRIMARY SOURCES

Verified peer schedules: Helix 2025-26, Steele Canyon 2025-26, Sweetwater Article XV, San Dieguito Schedule Q, San Diego Unified, San Marcos USD, Poway USD. CHSSO 2025-26 fee schedule. Pierpoint et al., *Concussion Prevention*, 2018 · OCR Resolution Letter, Morgan Hill USD (Live Oak HS), Oct 2023 · Malkus & Hollon, AEI, April 8 2026 (n=262,600). Granite Hills HS ASB statements (25 sport-specific PDFs); GUHSD *Request To Pay Coach – Trust* Google Form (53 requests, $96,009); *Sports Grid 2025-26* (52 stipends / 58 coaches / $313,200); NFHS, *The Case for High School Activities* (25-year compiled research base). Full report & sources: jdavis-netizen.github.io/guhsd-athletics-funding-report